Khao Soi

(Thai Coconut Noodle Soup)

My son max introduced me to this soup. The coconut broth is fragrant and rich, coating the noodles well. It is crazy flavorful and a crowd pleaser!

Origin

Hails from Northern Thailand (Chiang Mail) where the weather stays a bit cooler.

At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 20 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 30 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

Preparation – *Mis en place –Everything in its place*

Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.

- **Soak/Activate: Air fry tofu – salt and pepper and spray with Pam**
- **Soak/Activate: Kafir leaves for 20 minutes**
- **Chop – Garlic, lemongrass, shallots**
- **Finely slice- Mushrooms and julienne bell peppers**
- **Assemble Tools: Air fryer, pot for soup**

Ingredients

- **Primary Plant Protein/Base:**
- 2 tofu– firm or extra firm tofu – sliced long about 1 inch

- **Fresh Produce & Aromatics:**
- Baby bell mushrooms – 3 cups thinly sliced and cut in half
- shallots – 2 finely chopped
- red bell peppers- 2
- limes – 2 (one for broth, one for garnish)
- **Pantry Staples & Seasonings:**
- Lo mein noodles – fresh is best

Broth:

- coconut oil – 2 tbs
- shallot – 2 large finely diced (or sub half an onion)
- lemongrass - 6 tbs chopped (trim woody end at the top, stay away from the purple ring, slice the rest and finely mince)
- garlic cloves - 8 roughly chopped
- Thai red curry paste- 2 tbs (you can add more for greater spice)
- turmeric - 1 tsp
- curry powder - 1 tsp
- cardamom powder - 1 tsp
- light coconut milk - 2 14-ounce cans of
- 1 cup vegetable broth and 2 cups water
- kaffir lime leaves – 15
- fish sauce- 4 tbs
- soy sauce- 4 tbs – (2 dark, 2 light)
- brown sugar - 4 tbs
- chili garlic sauce – 2 tbs
- salt and pepper to taste
- 1 lime

🔪 Directions

Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"

1. **Prepare**
    1. Vegetables – cut each and place each type on a plate

2. **Pre- cook**
    1. Place tofu in air fryer – or can do on a griddle lightly sautéing on both sides.

3. **Ready– have all ingredients in front of you**

    Make the Broth
    In a large pot, heat oil over medium heat. Add shallot, garlic, and lemongrass. Sauté until fragrant and golden, about 3-4 minutes. Add mushrooms – cook until soften. Add red curry paste, add the spices, sauté for 1 minute. Add the coconut milk, broth, and lime leaves and bring to a simmer, stirring. Once gently simmering, add the fish sauce, sugar, soy sauce, and chili garlic paste.
    - **Add the tofu and gently simmer covered**. Avoid high flame – you don't what the coconut milk to separate.
    - **Add the peppers and simmer for 20-30 mins.**
    - Give a generous squeeze of lime. Taste, adding more lime/salt/pepper/ red curry paste if necessary. Find the balance between salty, sweet, acidic, and spicy.

    *** If the broth lacks depth, more fish sauce, soy sauce or salt. *Heat it up, so it's hot.*

    • Make noodles – place fresh noodles in boiling water for 4 minutes and then rinse in cold water.

4. **Serve**
    • Divide noodles into the bowls and ladle the hot soup over top this way it is a bit easier to handle.

5. **Garnishes/Toppings:** bean sprouts, cilantro or crunchy noodles, Thai basil and more lime wedges

💡 Quick Tips

Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.

- **Flavor Boost:** add more soy sauce and chili to taste
- **Substitution:** Can add bok choy, and any type of mushrooms you enjoy
- **Meal Prep Hack:** good for days in refrigerator or can freeze

Nutritional Information

Estimated values

Tofu -Firm	90-144 calories per 100g, 10-14 g protein, 7 g fiber, 2g low carbs, Fat - heart-healthy polyunsaturated fat, 0 cholesterol. Includes calcium, manganese, iron, copper, selenium, phosphorus, magnesium, zinc and vitamins A, B1, B2 and B5
Mushrooms	28 calories for 1 cup, 2.9 protein, 5.2 g carbs, and .3 g fat. Has high B complex vitamins and D2. Also, high in antioxidants, may help lower cholesterol, may help regulate blood sugar and may help support your immune
Peppers	28 calories (per 100 g), 2 grams of fiber, 1 gram of protein and very low fat Has nutrient-dense vegetables packed with vitamins (especially C, A, B6, K, E) and minerals (potassium, folate), providing antioxidants and fiber for digestive health
shallots	160 calories (per 100g), 2 g protein, 7 g fiber, 8.5 g Carbs, 15g healthy fats (most are monosaturated fat) Includes 20 different vitamins and minerals, notably: Potassium, Vitamins K, B9, C, E, and B6, magnesium & copper
Wheat noodles	123–340 calories, 5-9g of protein, 2-5g of fiber, and 0-3g of fat for 100g. They are generally low in fat, free of cholesterol, and offer nutrients like iron and B vitamins. They are high in complex carbohydrates (roughly 26-69g per serving), making them excellent for sustained energy. Whole wheat versions provide more fiber (about 2.8g to 5g) compared to refined wheat noodles. They can provide small amounts of iron, potassium, and B vitamins (Thiamin, Niacin).

What is tofu and is it good for you?

Tofu is a nutrient-dense, plant-based protein made from curdled soy milk pressed into blocks, offering a complete amino acid profile, high iron, and calcium. It is generally considered very healthy, supporting heart health, reducing risk of certain cancers, and aiding weight management. It is low-fat, cholesterolfree, and safe for daily consumption.

It is a nutrient-dense, plant-based complete protein containing all nine essential amino acids required by the body. Its nutritional profile varies primarily by its firmness; firmer varieties generally contain more protein, fat, and calories per serving because they have less water content.

- **Extra-Firm Tofu:** provides 15-17 g of protein, and 145 calories
- **Firm Tofu:** provides 8–10g of protein and 70-80 calories
- **Silken/Soft Tofu:** Higher in water content, providing about 4–7g of protein and 40–62 calories

Key Health Benefits

- **Heart Health:** Tofu is cholesterol-free, low in saturated fat, and may help reduce LDL cholesterol.
  Studies show eating at least one serving per week may lower heart disease risk by 18%.
- **Nutrient-Rich:** It is a good source of iron, manganese, selenium, phosphorus, and calcium, especially when made with calcium-sulfate.
- **Cancer Risk Reduction:** Tofu contains isoflavones, which have antioxidants, anti-inflammatory, and potential protective effects against breast, prostate, and colorectal cancers.
- **Bone Health:** The high calcium and magnesium content helps prevent osteoporosis.